

MiniLicensePlates.com

Routine guide — publish local changes to production (cPanel VPS)

Updated: May 24, 2026

Use this when: You have tested changes locally and want to update the live site at **<https://minilicenseplates.com>**.

Your setup (from project docs): Laravel app on cPanel · GitHub repo cdcoppercoins/aamlproj · GitHub Desktop for commits · server app root typically /home/minilp/new.minilicenseplates.com/ · plate images **not** in Git (public/plates/ uploaded separately).

Never commit: .env, vendor/, public/plates/, or mlp_code/.

Before you start

- ☐ Changes work on `http://localhost:8000`
- ☐ You know whether this deploy includes **new database migrations**
- ☐ You know whether this deploy includes **new Composer packages** (e.g. DomPDF)
- ☐ You have cPanel login and (if available) SSH or Terminal access

Step-by-step

1 Review what changed locally

Open GitHub Desktop. Confirm the changed files look correct — especially `public/main.css`, new Blade views, controllers, migrations, and `public/js/` if you added scripts. Do **not** stage `.env` or plate images.

2 Commit on your PC

In GitHub Desktop: write a short commit message describing the update → click **Commit to main** (or your working branch).

3 Push to GitHub

Click **Push origin** in GitHub Desktop. Wait until it completes with no errors.

4 Pull on the production server

Log into cPanel →

Terminal

(or use SSH). Run:

```
cd /home/minilp/new.minilicenseplates.com
git pull
```

If you deploy by FileZilla instead of Git: upload only the changed files to the same path on the server, preserving folder structure.

5 Install Composer packages (if needed)

Run this when `composer.json` OR `composer.lock` changed (e.g. DomPDF):

```
cd /home/minilp/new.minilicenseplates.com
composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader
```

Skip this step if you only changed CSS, views, or PHP that uses existing packages.

6 Run database migrations (if needed)

Run this when new files exist in `database/migrations/`:

```
cd /home/minilp/new.minilicenseplates.com
php artisan migrate --force
```

Skip if no new migrations. Never use phpMyAdmin alone for migrations — use Artisan.

7 Storage link (one-time or if missing)

Profile photos need the public storage symlink. Run once if not already done:

```
cd /home/minilp/new.minilicenseplates.com
php artisan storage:link
```

8 Copy CSS to the live web root

Production serves CSS from the document root. After editing `public/main.css`, copy it:

```
cp /home/minilp/new.minilicenseplates.com/public/main.css /home/minilp/public_html/main.css
```

Adjust the `public_html` path if your live layout differs. Also upload any new files under `public/js/`, `images`, or `banners` if you added them.

9 Clear Laravel caches

```
cd /home/minilp/new.minilicenseplates.com
php artisan config:clear
php artisan route:clear
php artisan view:clear
```

If you see config errors, delete stale files in `bootstrap/cache/` (keep `.gitignore`).

10 Verify production .env (only when settings changed)

In cPanel File Manager, open the server `.env` (not in Git). Typical values:

```
APP_URL=https://minilicenseplates.com
SESSION_DRIVER=database
DB_CONNECTION=mysql
DB_DATABASE=...
DB_USERNAME=...
DB_PASSWORD=...
```

Do not overwrite production `.env` with your local copy.

11 Test the live site

Hard-refresh the browser (Ctrl+F5). Check:

- Home page and new UI (banner rotator, styles)
- Sign in / register / log out
- My Collection and Edit by set
- Gallery and Catalog Search

12 Rollback plan (if something breaks)

- Git: `git log` then `git checkout <previous-commit>` or revert the bad commit
- Migrations: `php artisan migrate:rollback --step=1` (only if a migration caused the problem)
- Restore previous `main.css` from backup if styles broke

Files often changed in recent updates

Area	Paths
Home page / rotator	<code>config/home_hero.php</code> , <code>app/Http/Controllers/HomeController.php</code> , <code>resources/views/home.blade.php</code> , <code>resources/views/components/home-hero-rotator.blade.php</code> , <code>public/js/home-hero.js</code> , <code>public/main.css</code>
Header / log out	<code>resources/views/components/header.blade.php</code> , <code>public/main.css</code>
Collection	<code>app/Http/Controllers/CollectionController.php</code> , <code>resources/views/collection/</code> , migrations under <code>database/migrations/</code>
Layout scripts	<code>resources/views/layouts/app.blade.php</code>

Local quick test (before deploy)

```
cd d:\aamlproj
php artisan serve
```

Open `http://localhost:8000`. Confirm MySQL is running in XAMPP.